

PURPOSE: To allow for undisruptive verbal communication within the chamber.

INTRODUCED BY: Katie Chung

**BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND
SCIENCE SENATE:**

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

Though we are not allowed to speak out of turn, constant disruptions to tell people to stop whispering is a greater disruption. It is important to have a formal senate environment, however, there is a line between being formal and being strict. What senators do is important, but it is just as important for senators to feel comfortable and enjoy themselves while they are in the chamber. Allowing for verbal communication among the chamber would allow for a more easy-going senate environment.

SECTION TWO (PROPOSED ACTION):

Verbal communication between members shall be permitted in the chamber if it does not disrupt proceedings, interfere with a member who has the floor, or prevent the presiding officer from conducting business. The presiding officer shall determine whether verbal communication is disruptive and may direct members to cease communication when necessary.

SECTION THREE (APPENDIX):

“I believe it is important for senators to have discussions in an undisruptive way during the session so that if there are small things can be cleared up without making the meeting longer by going through the rules of order process to individually ask another senator to answer a question.” – Senator Mantri

“I certainly think a little whispering every now and then would be ok, but I can definitely see this getting out of hand. Some senators might disagree over what constitutes “non-disruptive” communication, so Vice President Lister would have to be very clear about this.” – Senator Clemons

“I think Senate would benefit from nondisruptive whispering, for it facilitates the debate through exchange of thoughts while being discrete enough to not disturb the whole chamber. However, under the discretion of the presiding Vice President makes it unclear what amplitude of sound is applicable, so it may be possible that nondisruptive whispering would be defined as none at all.”
– Senator Tran